

Subject: Update regarding the Albuquerque Islamic Center (9600 2nd Street NW)

Dear Neighbor,

We are writing to share a brief update regarding our project at 9600 2nd Street NW.

As part of our commitment to being transparent and active members of the community, we want to clarify that our proposal includes a licensed daycare and K-12 school located entirely within the main building. Our goal is to create a community hub that serves local families by providing a safe, integrated space for education and worship.

To ensure we remain "good neighbors," we have designed the site with 235 parking spaces. This is more than double the county requirement, ensuring that all school and congregational traffic remains safely on-site and does not overflow onto our local streets.

Attached is our full Written Statement. Please see page 5 for specific details regarding the school, hours of operation, and site layout.

We look forward to being a peaceful, positive addition to the neighborhood. If you have any questions or would like to introduce yourself, please feel free to reach out to us at support@abqislamiccenter.org.

Sincerely,

The Albuquerque Islamic Center Team

Written Statement

Explain how the site for the proposed use is adequate in size and shape:

Certainly, a 3.87-acre parcel of land provides ample space for a mosque. Let me explain why:

1. **Land Area:** A 3.87-acre this is equivalent to at least **three football fields**. Such a sizable area allows for various facilities and activities.
2. **Mosque Space:**
 - o **Main Building:** A mosque typically includes a **prayer hall**, ablution areas, and administrative rooms. With 3.87 acres, there's room for a spacious main building.
 - o **Outdoor Areas:** The land can accommodate **courtyards, gardens, and open spaces** for congregants to gather, especially during festivals or community events.
 - o **Parking:** Adequate parking space for worshippers' vehicles can be allocated.
3. **Community Engagement:**
 - o Mosques serve as community centers. With this land size, you can host educational programs, daycare, social events, and outreach activities.
4. **Natural Beauty:**
 - o The extra space allows for **landscaping**, planting trees, and creating a serene environment.
 - o A **peaceful setting** enhances the spiritual experience for worshippers.

In summary, a 3.87-acre plot provides ample room for a mosque, supporting both its functional needs and community engagement.

Explain how the proposed use will not have an adverse effect on the neighborhood or seriously conflict with the character of the area:

The proposed mosque will harmonize with the neighborhood and maintain the character of the area:

1. **Zoning compatibility:** The fact that the mosque is **allowed conditionally by the county zoning map** is a significant positive. It demonstrates that local authorities have already assessed its compatibility with the surrounding land use.
2. **Location:** The Islamic center is advantageous for the location:
 - **Buffer Zone:** It provides a buffer between the residential use on the north boundary and the commercial on the south on Alameda. The Center acts as a **smooth transition between** the existing houses and commercial.
 - **Visual Aesthetics:** The Center with its own architecture and landscaping will provide a **visual aesthetics** of the area. It prevents overcrowding and maintains a sense of openness.
3. **Community Engagement:**
 - The mosque can actively engage with the community. Regular **open houses, interfaith dialogues, and cultural events** can foster understanding and goodwill.
 - **Community Outreach:** The mosque can collaborate with local schools, charities, and other organizations. This strengthens community bonds.
4. **Architectural Design:**
 - The mosque's design should **complement** the existing architectural style of the area. Using similar materials and aesthetics ensures it blends harmoniously.
 - **Landscaping:** Thoughtful landscaping can enhance the area. Consider native plants, green spaces, and water features.
5. **Traffic Management:**
 - Work with local authorities to address any potential traffic concerns. Adequate parking and traffic flow plans are essential.
 - **Peak Times:** Coordinate prayer times to minimize traffic during peak hours.
6. **Lighting and Signage:**
 - Ensure exterior lighting is **subdued** and doesn't spill into neighboring properties.
 - **Modest Signage:** Signage should be informative yet **unobtrusive**.
7. **Environmental Impact:**
 - The mosque can adopt **sustainable practices** (such as rainwater harvesting, solar panels, and energy-efficient design).
 - **Green Spaces:** Create green areas that benefit both worshippers and the community.

In summary, the proposed mosque, when thoughtfully planned and integrated, can coexist harmoniously with the neighborhood. It's essential to maintain open communication with residents, address concerns, and celebrate the positive contributions the mosque will bring to the community.

Explain the specific details concerning your proposal (hours, size, number of clients.. Etc.:

The specific details regarding the proposed mosque:

1. Hours of Operation:

- The mosque's operational hours will vary, but the **peak service time** is on **Fridays at noon**. This aligns with the congregational Jumu'ah prayer, which holds special significance for Muslims.
- On other days, the mosque will be open for regular prayers throughout the day. However, the visitor will be less than 25 persons. In addition to the prayers 100 students are expected to attend the school and the daycare. However, the expected traffic will be significant.

2. Building Size and Design:

- The mosque's building will be approximately **50,000 square feet**.
- It will be a **two story structure**, combining functionality with architectural aesthetics.
- Here's a breakdown of the building's layout:
 - **Ground Floor:**
 - **Prayer Hall:** The heart of the mosque, where daily prayers take place. It accommodates worshippers during regular prayers.
 - **Ablution Areas:** Adjacent to the prayer hall, providing facilities for ritual purification (wudu).
 - **Community Rooms:** Spaces for meetings, classes, and community events.
 - **Library:** A quiet area for reading religious texts and educational materials.
 - **Administrative Offices:** For mosque management and coordination.
 - **Upper Floor (Half-Story):**
 - **Women's Prayer Area:** A separate section for female worshippers.
 - **Classrooms:** Used for religious education, language classes, and youth programs.
 - **Imam's office:** Where the mosque's spiritual leader conducts counseling and guidance.
 - **Balcony:** Overlooking the prayer hall, providing additional capacity during peak times.

3. Visitors and Congregants:

- **Daily Visitors:** On regular days, the mosque expects around **100 visitors** throughout the day. These include worshippers, students, and community members.
- **Friday Noon (Jumu'ah):**
 - **Prayer Congregation:** The peak hours occur during the Friday Jumu'ah prayer.
 - **Approximately 250 worshippers** gather for the sermon (khutbah) and the congregational prayer.
 - The mosque will accommodate this larger congregation during the Friday service at noon.

In summary, the proposed mosque aims to serve the community by providing a serene space for worship, education, and fellowship. Its design and operations are carefully planned to align with both functional needs and the neighborhood's character.

Incidental Facilities: Integrated Educational & Childcare Services

Proposed Facilities: The project includes an integrated educational component consisting of a licensed daycare, preschool/kindergarten, and a comprehensive K-12 school (Primary, Middle, and High School levels). These facilities are located **entirely within the primary building structure**, ensuring a cohesive architectural footprint that maintains the open-space character of the 3.87-acre site.

Facility Breakdown & Capacity: The interior layout is meticulously designed to accommodate approximately 350 students and 50 daycare attendees. The academic wing includes:

- **Early Childhood:** 3 dedicated daycare rooms and 3 rooms for KG/Preschool.
- **K-12 Education:** 8 primary classrooms, 6 middle school classrooms, and 3 high school classrooms.

Shared Infrastructure & Efficiency: To maximize the utility of the site while minimizing the building's physical "bulk," the project utilizes a **shared-use model** for high-occupancy areas. The gymnasium and basketball facilities serve a dual purpose: providing physical education space for students during school hours and community recreation space for the mosque congregation during evenings and weekends.

Parking and Traffic Superiority: A critical feature of this proposal is the abundance of on-site parking, which significantly mitigates any impact on public streets.

- **Calculated Requirement:** Based on local code, the school requires 51 spaces and the mosque requires 50, for a total of **101 required spaces**.
- **Proposed Provision:** The site plan provides **235 parking spaces**—exceeding the legal requirement by **132%**. > This massive surplus ensures that all student drop-off, staff parking, and congregational activities occur entirely on-site, preventing any "overflow" into the surrounding neighborhood and ensuring a safe, fluid traffic pattern even during peak transition times.

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FCM LETTER

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Albuquerque Islamic Center

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Albuquerque, NM 87112

To: Property Owner / Resident of:

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